

upGrad

Online
Programmes



Advanced Certificate in **Digital Brand Communication Strategy**

14 Weeks

Online

20%

Strategy

80%

Practice

100%

Brand Impact

Master Digital Brand Communication Strategy.

**Build Loved Brands.
Drive Long-Term Growth.**

Learn how to go from insight to identity, content, community and business outcomes – powered by **MICA**.

Why a Career in Digital Brand Communication Strategy?

Digital brand strategy sits at the intersection of insight, creativity and growth. Brand strategists build narratives, communities and experiences that compound over time across social, e-commerce, quick commerce and offline touchpoints.

■ ₹ 14 LPA (AVG)

Average salary of a Brand Manager,
with mid-senior roles ranging ₹12–22 LPA

(Source: Glassdoor India)

■ \$ 87.5 Billion

India's D2C & digital-first brand market in 2025

(Source: Mordor Intelligence, 2025)

■ 44%

Share of India's total ad spends on digital

(Source: ET Brand Equity–Ipsos, 2025)

■ 24% CAGR

Growth rate of India's creator economy (2025–2032)

(Source: Coherent Market Insights, 2025)

If you are a marketer, content creator, founder or growth professional who wants to build brands—not just run campaigns—this programme is designed for you.

*Figures are indicative and based on publicly available reports as of 2025.

Key Programme Highlights

14 Weeks

60+ Live Learning Hours

15+ Content, Marketing and AI Tools

2-Part Capstone

2 Valuable Credentials

MICA Advanced Certificate + CleverTap Analytics Certificate

Case Studies from Leading D2C Brands

Get Executive Alumni Status from MICA

Note: This is a live sessions-based program. The live sessions in the program will be taken by a combination of industry experts and MICA faculty.

Programme **Structure**

Course 1:

Brand Strategy and Communication Foundations

Build brands with sharp positioning, cultural relevance,
and clear long-term differentiation

(Weeks 1-4)



Course 2:

Content, Social & Creator-Led Growth

Drive demand and engagement through high-impact content,
social platforms, and creator ecosystems

(Weeks 5-9)



Course 3:

Brand Growth to Business Growth

Turn brand strength into measurable business
outcomes—revenue, retention, and market share

(Weeks 10-14)

Programme Curriculum

14 Weeks | 28 Live Sessions | 3 Courses | 2-Part Capstone Project

Course 1: Brand Strategy and Communication Foundations



1. Decoding Customer Insight and Positioning

- Find disruptive customer insight using AI research
- Translate insight into positioning that creates preference
- Build a point of view customers adopt as identity
- Craft your message architecture and proof library

Key Topics:

Customer Insight > Promise > Proof > Brand POV, benefit ladder, sub-segment messaging, Regional market positioning (Tier 2/3 city adaptations, local vs metro messaging), Brand voice, POV frameworks, Message hierarchy, tone and language system, AI rewriting in multiple voices

2. Building an Identity and Narrative System

- Turn strategy into a brand narrative that emotionally sticks
- Build a visual system with AI exploration
- Turn packaging into trial and word-of-mouth
- Build scalable architecture for future products

Key Topics:

Brand narrative spine, archetypes, founder vs functional story, regional storytelling adaptation, Mobile-first storytelling, AI-assisted moodboards, Hero SKU design, unboxing rituals, shelf standout Quick commerce packaging, regional packaging

Course 2: Content, Social & Creator-Led Growth



3. Creating a Content Engine with AI

- Build a repeatable content machine that doesn't rely on inspiration
- Make content that stops the scroll and increases watch time
- Make creatives that persuade and convert, not just look pretty
- Turn content into conversions without being “salesy”

Key Topics:

Content pillar strategy, hero–hub–help framework, AI topic clustering, Regional language content strategy, Translation vs transcreation; Short-form scriptwriting with AI, Vertical video storytelling for mobile, UGC for persuasion, Shoppable content basics

4. Leading Across Platforms

- Win attention and category authority on platforms that matter
- Build founder / brand authority for inbound leads

Key Topics:

Format strategy, content analytics, Live commerce setup (Instagram Live Shopping, YouTube Live Shopping), Shoppable Reels and Shorts (product tagging, in-video commerce best practices), Instagram Shop setup, YouTube Shorts for brand building, Founder brand vs corporate brand balance

5. Influencer and UGC-led Brand Growth

- Turn creators into predictable growth — without overspending
- Build a scalable UGC pipeline that produces conversion-first creatives

Key Topics:

Influencer funnel, rate benchmarking, briefs, outreach automation using AI, performance tracking for influencer campaigns, Regional nano/micro influencer strategy, UGC scripts, Mobile-first UGC specs

6. Community Building

- Convert followers into fans and superfans into advocates
- Execute a brand rollout with momentum and buzz

Key Topics:

Community platform playbooks, Vernacular and regional community management, WhatsApp community features & workflows, Crisis management, Festive marketing strategy & cultural storytelling

Capstone Project Part 1:

Building and Growing a D2C Brand

Course 3:

Brand Growth to Business Growth



7. Revenue Growth Architecture

- ▶ Turn brand storytelling into conversions
- ▶ Design pricing, offers and catalog to drive trial
- ▶ Maximise lifetime value with close-to-brand CRM
- ▶ Increase revenue without increasing ad spend

Key Topics:

Conversion psychology & landing page optimisation, Brand-led CAC reduction, Quick commerce presence & SKU strategy, CRM & retention, Omnichannel experience & reputation management, Loyalty mechanics & long-term value building

8. Campaign and Media Planning

- ▶ Go from idea to integrated marketing campaign
- ▶ Build the media plan that allocates budgets intelligently

Key Topics:

Big idea development, creative brief template, storyboarding, Reach/frequency strategy, media allocation, MMM thinking

9. Measurement and Decision-Making

- ▶ Measure brand equity and drive decisions using dashboards
- ▶ Tell a data-backed story that leadership wants to fund
- ▶ Speak the language of finance to justify brand budgets
- ▶ Learn to defend brand investments, handle questions, and influence decision-making

Key Topics:

Brand health dashboard, brand search volume, Problem to Insight to Strategy to Executive structure and presentation, CAC, LTV, contribution, payback periods, ROI confidence, Handling stakeholders, building a narrative

Capstone Project Part 2:

Final Boardroom Pitch

The Capstone Experience

Master the full brand-building journey—from insight and identity to content, community and boardroom storytelling. Turn your brand plan into a defensible business case.

Part A

Building & Growing a D2C Brand

- Define a clear D2C brand positioning from insight
- Build an integrated brand + growth playbook
- Create a realistic go-to-market strategy



Part B

Final Boardroom Pitch

- Present an end-to-end brand-to-revenue strategy
- Use dashboards and KPIs to justify decisions
- Defend investments with a strong financial case



Key Tools **You'll Learn**

Some Brand **Case Studies You'll Study**

Note: The list of tools and brand case studies is an indicative list only and is subject to change as per the discretion of the institution.
MICA and upGrad do not promote or endorse these tools/brands.

Learn from MICA Faculty & Industry Experts



Prof. Siddharth Deshmukh
Adjunct Faculty,
MICA




Teaching Fellow,
University of
Southampton


Ex-Director, Product and
Marketing


Ex-Product
Manager



Prof. Anita Basalingappa
Professor of Marketing,
MICA




Ex-Pavate Fellow in Marketing,
Cambridge Judge Business School

Ex-Academic Associate,
Marketing, IIM-A



Prof. Falguni Vasavada-Oza
Professor of Marketing,
MICA




Speaker, TEDx,
Hyderabad


Content Creator &
Influencer



Prof. Sukaran Thakur
Adjunct Faculty,
MICA



Ex-Strategy Consultant,
Unilever

Ex-Marketing
Manager, L'Oréal

Ex-Brand Manager,
ITC Limited



Nikhil Kant
Head of Marketing




Ex. Head of Social


Ex. Global Social
Media Lead


Ex. Consultant



Siddharth Kapur
Independent Brand &
GTM Strategist



Ex. Mentor & Investor


Ex. Business Head, Adult
Nutrition & Wellness


Ex. Global Brand
Manager



Richa Parekh
Digital Marketing Lead




Ex. Head, Digital
Marketing


Ex. Digital Marketing
Manager


Ex. Project Manager

Note 1: Please note that the list of experts is indicative and may vary from one batch to another.
Note 2: Logos and brand names shown are for identification purposes only and represent the past or present professional affiliations of the faculty and industry experts. Their use does not imply any endorsement, association, or partnership with the programme or its organisers.

Career **Support Services**

Career services powered by upGrad



Role-specific
Career Coaching
(Brand, Content & Growth)



CV, **Portfolio** & LinkedIn
optimisation



Just-in-time mock
interviews



Interview prep and
personal branding
for marketers



Job portal access
& curated brand roles

MICA Programme Certification

Online
Programmes



in association with

upGrad

This is to certify that

Name

has successfully completed the 14 weeks online programme

and has been awarded the

Advanced Certificate in

Digital Brand Communication Strategy

on DD MM,YYYY

PROF. SIDDHARTH DESHMUKH
Programme Director

PROF. ANITA BASALINGAPPA
Lead - Online Programmes

MS. JAYA DESHMUKH
Director & CEO
MICA

STUDENT ID: 000000

Disclaimer: This is a sample certificate design and is subject to change at the discretion of the institution.

Earn a Marketing Analytics Certificate from **CleverTap**



Why CleverTap Certification Helps

- Used by 2,000+ brands across 100+ countries, making it one of the most widely adopted customer engagement platforms globally
- Hundreds of live job roles worldwide (CRM, Growth, Lifecycle, Retention) explicitly mention CleverTap as a required or preferred skill
- ~75% of companies today use marketing automation tools, so CleverTap skills directly map to high-demand, real-world roles

ABOUT MICA

MICA is India's premier institute for Strategic Marketing & Communication, known for shaping leaders in brand management, digital marketing, and creative strategy for over three decades.

Located in Ahmedabad, MICA is consistently ranked among the top Indian institutions for marketing and communication studies. Its alumni lead brand, growth, and marketing teams at global consumer, tech, and D2C brands.

This Advanced Program in Digital Brand Communication Strategy is designed and delivered by MICA faculty and industry experts in collaboration with upGrad.



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ABOUT **upGrad**

upGrad is a leading global learning and workforce development company. We're on a mission to power career success for professionals worldwide as their trusted lifelong learning partner. Since 2015, over 10 million learners have upskilled with us across marketing, technology, management, and data programs designed and delivered with top universities and industry leaders in India and abroad. Our marketing and brand programs are co-created with institutions like MICA, The School of Ideas, to blend academic rigour with real-world outcomes.



Ronnie Screwvala

Co-founder & Executive Chairman



GSV EDTECH 150

Top 150 Most Transformative
Growth Companies



**BRANDON HALL
GOLD AWARDS**

15+ Across 2 Years



PROMISING BRAND 2022
The Economic Times



**EDUCATION COMPANY
OF THE YEAR**
VC Circle, 2022

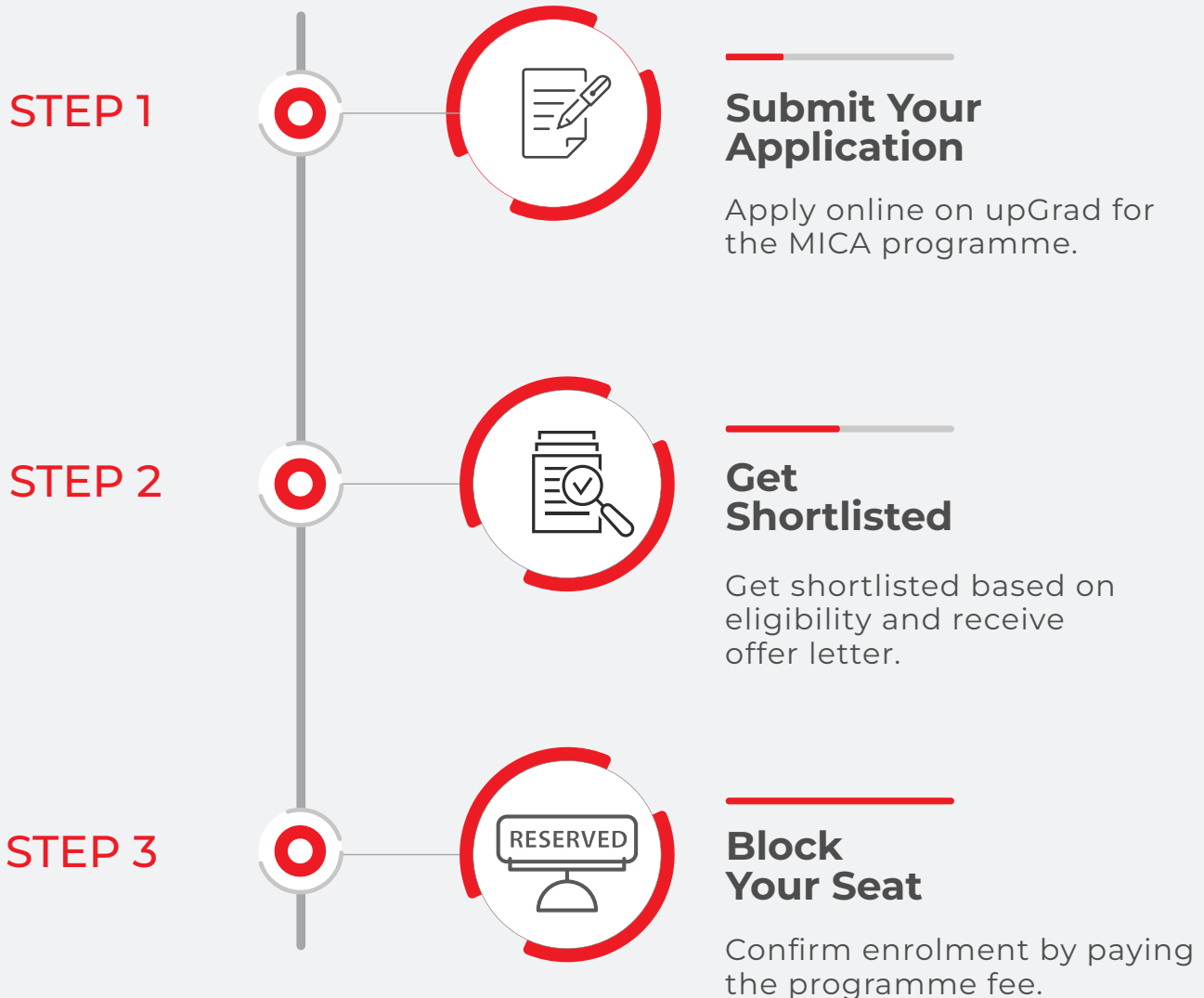


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**EDUCATION INNOVATION
AWARDS 2020**
Best Communication &
Teaching Platform



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Eligibility: A bachelor's degree in any domain from a recognised university



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LET'S TALK
